

MICROSOFT'S PROJECT PINK GIVES RISE TO Kin One and Kin Two



Project Pink has laid itself bare, unveiling the names of the devices that were codenamed Turtle (left) and Pure (right). The siblings emerging: the smaller, vertical sliding Turtle shall be called Kin One; the bigger, horizontal sliding Pure will be Kin Two.

Featuring a whole new breed of Windows - a cloud-based social networking OS - the Sidekick inspired phones are manufactured by Sharp, survive on instant messaging, and sport the following specifications:

The two compact, sturdily-built devices shall launch in May, with Verizon Wireless in the United States and Vodafone (Germany, Italy, Spain and UK) in Europe. Their social networking geared operating systems have an easy on the eye Metro UI interface, but

features - no browser support for Flash Lite or Silverlight; no native image/video editing software; and for social phones, it is surprising they do not have a universal inbox or calendar support.

The phones however, while not offering advanced func-

tionality with both PCs and Macs. The cloud-based custom Kin OS automatically uploads images and videos to the Kin server with a service called Kin Studio, and you just need to log in to find them all in your limitless online storage. Kin Spot, another service, plays the role of picture sharing/uploading tool for the social networking sites, primarily supporting only Facebook and MySpace. Kin Loop is the news, event and update stream, continuously feeding data in realtime, unless the user opts-out explicitly. The phones also offer HD video recording.

The capacitive touchscreens sport a gesture-based multi-touch interface, and it looks responsive. In short, these phones are geared towards feature-rich seamless simplicity, instead of subtle intricacies, and serve their calm purpose with Silverlight. 



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are not quite Windows Phone 7, and do not offer much choice in terms of expandability, missing some core elements alongside a few advanced

functionalities, still manage to serve up a lot - with their economical Zune pass, and their Zune HD players and Zune-based browsers, which are compat-

	KIN One	KIN Two
Display	2.6" TFT, QVGA (320 x 240) capacitive touch screen	3.4" TFT, QVGA (480 x 320) capacitive touch screen
Camera	5.0MP CMOS with anti-shake, autofocus, dual LED flash	8.0MP HDR CMOS from Omnivision with anti-shake, autofocus, Lumi LED flash
Memory	256MB DDR RAM, 4GB storage	256MB DDR RAM, 8GB storage
Connectivity	EV-DO Rev A, Bluetooth 2.1 w/A2DP, Hi-speed USB, 802.11b/g	EV-DO Rev A, Bluetooth 2.1 w/A2DP, Hi-speed USB, 802.11b/g
Speakers	Mono	Stereo
Battery	1240 mAh	1390 mAh
Form Factor	Vertical slide, QWERTY	Horizontal slide, QWERTY
Others	Assisted GPS, FM radio, accelerometer	Assisted GPS, FM radio, accelerometer